Gordons, Port Moresby, Papua New Guinea

At Gordons, El Niño arrives three ways: as a price, as a water timetable, and as a sick child who was already thin. The sweet potato on the stalls comes from the Highlands, and it already costs a third more than last year. Water is rationed, and the suburb is split across two zones. Malnutrition makes every other illness here deadlier. The most important step is to put rehydration salts, water treatment, and child-malnutrition screening where people already gather: the market gate, the bus stop, and the clinic. The second is to keep the market open and the Highlands produce coming.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
National Capital District, PNG (inferred)	None published for Papua New Guinea	n/a here; global 6-month figure 239,000 ± 11,000	Staple food prices rising, water rationing split across two zones, diarrhoea and dengue in children already malnourished, and market closures that cut income and food at once

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



9.43°S 147.20°E, Papua New Guinea · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Rationed water and rising staple prices make diarrhoea deadly for already-malnourished children: 2010 cholera hit neighbouring Erima, 8-Mile, and 9-Mile, and severely malnourished children were 36% of Port Moresby General's 2012 child deaths.
- **First action.** Now, PNG Red Cross (NCD) and the NCD Provincial Health Authority stock rehydration salts and zinc at the market and Gordons Clinic, with a standing backup-clinic rule.*
- **The money.** $42k floor, $67k target, $187k ceiling; the top placement is $36,000 to PNG Red Cross (NCD) for sachets, rehydration salts, and zinc.
- **Do not.** Do not disconnect illegal settlement water connections during rationing: it pushes people onto unsafe water when cholera risk is highest, as the 2010 settlement outbreak showed.

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

25/25 recommendations checked. 1 confirmed, 13 corrected, 2 unverified, and 9 contraindicated. Two of the contraindicated items rest on thin evidence and are kept as precautions. Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab, September 2026, pre-peer-review, heat only. It publishes no figure for Papua New Guinea, and heat is not the main hazard here. No number is borrowed. **This revision replaces the 10 October briefing.** It adds an eighth lens, on food supply chains, and corrects four facts from the first version: the Gordons Clinic closure was 3–9 February 2025, not March; the clinic sees 400–500 patients a day (the earlier 3,000 a month had no source); the 2016 move of TB services to Six Mile was temporary; and the 2011 clash had five reported deaths, but police confirmed two to three. The funding target is $67k, 18% below the panel's $82k and 31% above the first version's $51k. The increase pays for child-malnutrition treatment.

Where this is. Gordons is a suburb in the Moresby North-East electorate of the National Capital District (NCD). It holds Gordons Market, rebuilt for about USD 10M by New Zealand and the National Capital District Commission (NCDC) and opened on 6 November 2019 for more than 2,000 vendors. It also holds the Gordons industrial area, Gordons Clinic, and the public-motor-vehicle (PMV) bus stop at nearby Unagi Oval. No published population count exists; the funding section assumes 25,000–50,000 people served. The nearest settlements named in sources are Erima, 8-Mile, 9-Mile, Morata, and the Erima Wildlife ridge. In March 2026 police were given eviction orders for the Erima ridge and Tete settlement, and two people died in an eviction at Rabiagini in January, so anyone counting houses here is likely to be taken for an eviction survey.

What the forecast and the market say. A strong El Niño is under way: NOAA's Oceanic Niño Index for July–September 2026 is about +2.2, on the 1997 track. Port Moresby is the driest place in New Guinea, with a June–November dry season, and the Fire Service called conditions "extremely dry" on 29 June. On 14–16 August Water PNG rationed the city in four zones after leaks on the 1960s Rouna 1/3 main, which carries about half the city's raw water. Its chief executive said a burst could cut more than half the supply "for weeks or months", because "no spare pipe of this size is held in the country." The food shock is already visible. In April–June 2026, Port Moresby sweet potato prices were 35% above a year earlier and taro 43%, adjusted for inflation (FPDA/IFPRI). On 17 September, frost and drought were reported cutting Highlands harvests, with up to 3 million people at risk.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

HOW FOOD REACHES GORDONS

SUPPLY CHAIN

New in this revision: the eighth lens maps where El Niño breaks the chain, and the verifier corrected it.

- **Staples come from the Highlands; most other produce does not.** The Highlands supplied 95% of staple fresh produce (sweet potato, potato, cabbage, onion, carrot) at Gordon's market in 2024. Central Province and NCD supply cooking banana, about 28% of taro, tomatoes, and fruit, and roughly two-thirds of all fresh produce by volume. Gordons' exposure to drought is therefore a staples exposure (IFPRI Working Paper 13, March 2026).
- **The route is long and the margin is mostly cost.** Produce goes from Mt Hagen to Lae by road in under a day, then by ship to Port Moresby in 4–5 days. The farmer's share of the Port Moresby sweet potato price is 21%; the rest is marketing, freight, and spoilage. A rise in Highlands prices squeezes the resellers first: they buy fewer bags with the cash they have, and the stalls thin out before any price bulletin shows it.
- **Imported rice is the fallback.** About 80% of PNG's food is grown in the country, but nearly all rice is imported, and one importer (Trukai) held about 80% of the market in 2016. In 1997, rice imports rose by 66,000 tonnes and 76% of the extra was sold through shops. In the 2015–16 drought, rice sales rose by an estimated 35–40%. Rice cost K4.35 a kilo in June 2026 (2021 kina) and peaked at K4.94 in Port Moresby in May. No 2026 rice export ban by India was found, and global stocks are high, so the risk is a price spike, not empty shelves.
- **Households have little room.** A healthy diet for a Port Moresby household costs 45% of a low-skill worker's daily wage, and only 53% of low-skill urban workers in PNG eat a minimally diverse diet (IFPRI, 2025). Across 44 countries, a 5% real rise in food prices over three months was associated with 9% more child wasting and 14% more severe wasting (Headey & Ruel 2023).
- **Nobody is watching closely.** FPDA ran one Port Moresby price round in April, two in May, one in June, and none in July or August. Its bulletin is quarterly, two months late, and in 2021 kina. There is no record of how many Highlands bags arrive at Gordons.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO

RANKED

Actions are ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort. Because the dry season is under way, the dates mean now. Backing lenses are shown on each action, and the RACI chart below assigns each one. Actions 10–12 are city-wide asks that decide whether money and water

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

reach Gordons at all.

1. Put rehydration salts and zinc at a market point and at Gordons Clinic, with a standing rule that a backup clinic opens a diarrhoea corner the day Gordons Clinic shuts *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · PHILANTHROPIST · FRONTLINE | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
PNG Red Cross (NCD) with the NCD Provincial Health Authority; vendor leaders distribute	Now	~$5k salts and zinc (in funding)	Diarrhoea and cholera deaths when rationing pushes people onto stored water

Oral rehydration salts may prevent 93% of diarrhoea deaths in children under five (Munos, Fischer Walker & Black 2010, a modelled estimate from meta-analyses). In the 2009–11 cholera epidemic, the death rate among cases was 0.1% in NCD against 8.8% in Western Province, because treatment was close. In 2010 the cholera centre at Port Moresby General Hospital took patients from Erima, 8-Mile, and 9-Mile, Gordons' neighbours. Gordons Clinic sees 400–500 patients a day and closed from 3 to 9 February 2025, when the health authority sent patients to Six Mile and 9-Mile; make that redirect a standing rule with salts already stocked there. At the same point, give vitamin A to children aged 6–59 months who have not had a dose in six months: preventive dosing cuts all-cause child deaths by 12% (Imdad, Cochrane 2022, RR 0.88).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: vitamin A is a six-monthly preventive dose, not a diarrhoea treatment. The "3,000 patients a month" figure in the first version had no source. The vitamin A trials were in healthy children in the community, not in Melanesia.

2. Screen children for malnutrition with arm tapes at the market, the bus stop, and the clinic, and treat severe cases as outpatients with therapeutic food *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST · FOOD SUPPLY | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
NCD Provincial Health Authority treats; PNG Red Cross volunteers screen; UNICEF PNG supplies therapeutic food	Screening from November	~$6k screening; up to $25k treatment	Deaths of wasted children from diarrhoea, dengue, and TB as food prices rise

Malnutrition is what turns this event's other hazards into deaths. At the Port Moresby General Hospital children's wards in 2012, 12.6% of admissions had severe malnutrition, and those children made up 36% of all deaths, with 23% of them dying (UNICEF, citing hospital statistics). In a five-province sample including Port Moresby (2018), 13.8% of children were wasted and 46.5% stunted. Rising food prices raise wasting quickly (Headey & Ruel 2023). Outpatient treatment with ready-to-use therapeutic food cost $203 per child treated and $53 per year of healthy life gained in Lusaka (Bachmann 2009); published costs range from $56 to $805 per child. UNICEF already supplies therapeutic food to NCD government clinics.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the hospital figures are from 2012 and are not peer-reviewed; the 13.8% is not a national figure; PNG's 2016–18 health survey measured no children, so no NCD or Gordons malnutrition rate exists. No PNG trial of outpatient treatment was found, so its effect here is extrapolated from Africa. Before funding treatment, confirm with UNICEF PNG and the health authority that therapeutic food is in stock; if it is, the $25k falls.

3. Give households without piped water two water-treatment sachets a day, and add lidded containers if money allows; build water points at the market only after the city commits in writing to running them *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
PNG Red Cross with vendor leaders; NCDC Markets and Water PNG for any water point	Sachets now; water points after NCDC signs	$24k sachets (target); containers and water points in the ceiling	Diarrhoea from untreated stored water; dengue mosquitoes in open containers

Flocculant-disinfectant sachets cut diarrhoea episodes by about a third (RR 0.69; Clasen et al., Cochrane 2015). Across water-treatment trials, including sachet trials in Kenya and Guatemala, the odds of a child dying before five fell by 24–27% (Kremer et al. 2023). Each sachet treats 10 litres, so a household of six needs two a day. Rationing tells people to store water "in containers and buckets", and open containers breed dengue mosquitoes, so lids matter. Put any water point at the bus stop and outside the gate, where buyers actually are, with a named caretaker.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the Kremer cost-effectiveness figure ($27–66 per year of healthy life) was costed for chlorine dispensers, not sachets. Most trials were rural, so target settlement households with no piped water. The $12 container kit and $3k water point are unsourced, so both sit in the ceiling. The market's own water supply could not be confirmed.

4. Relay Water PNG's zone notice every morning at the market gate and the bus stop, and run a 5:30–8am water and rehydration point there

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · EMERGENCY MGR | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Water PNG publishes; women vendors and ward leaders relay; PNG Red Cross runs the point	Every rationing cycle	Volunteer time; printing under K5,000 (estimate)	Households missing their only supply window

Gordons is split across Water PNG's map. In the August rationing, "Gordon Industrial" was in Zone 2 and "parts of Gordons" in Zone 4, on different 8-hour windows, and the notice never said which streets were in which. The market opens at 8am, and in 2020 vendors complained that buyers had moved to the bus stop, so women are already selling outside the gate before opening. Brief a few women from each province's selling block to pass the timetable on by word of mouth, in Tok Pisin and Hiri Motu, with no forms and no lists.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: no street-level zoning exists, and no rationing notice since August was found; until Water PNG publishes one, the message is that Gordons spans two zones with no fixed schedule. Whether UN Women's Safe City alumni or the city wardens are still active in 2026 is unconfirmed.

5. Agree now that the market stays open through the dry season: mediation instead of closure, a pre-agreed relocation site, no clearances, and a vendor phone tree that checks on food and water within 48 hours of any shutdown

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · HISTORIAN · FOOD SUPPLY | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
NCDC Markets with Gordon police and vendor block leaders; church and community leaders mediate	Now; first step is naming the vendors' counterpart	Near zero	Income and food cut together, at the time food prices rise

Closing Gordons has been the standard response to trouble: after the January 2011 clash, from December 2011 to January 2012, for ten days in November 2014 after a police constable was killed at the bus stop, from September 2017 for the rebuild, and after the April 2023 flood. Clashes near the market were reported again on 18 October 2024. In a drought, a closure turns a security incident into a food crisis for the suburbs that buy there. The 2011 police-brokered peace meeting is a precedent for mediation; the 2014 move of sellers to Lareva and Boroko is a precedent for a relocation site.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: no relocation site or vendors' body is on record for 2026, so the first step is to find out who speaks for the vendors now. A no-closure agreement would be new policy in PNG.

6. Start a weekly Gordons food log now (nominal prices of sweet potato, rice, and greens, and the number of Highlands bags arriving), and ask FPDA to restore twice-monthly Port Moresby price rounds

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY · HISTORIAN · ECONOMIST | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
NCDC Markets with vendor leaders (log); Fresh Produce Development Agency (FPDA) (rounds)	From mid-October; baseline in 2–4 weeks	~K15–25k for clerks (lens estimate, unverified)	Responders acting blind through the peak; aid that follows politics instead of prices

Nobody recorded what food cost at Gordons in 1997 or 2015. FPDA's Port Moresby price rounds have gaps (none in July or August 2026), and its bulletin is quarterly, two months late, and in inflation-adjusted 2021 kina. A weekly count of Highlands bags arriving is the earliest signal, because resellers cut volume before prices move. Proposed triggers, to be set once the baseline exists: Highlands bag arrivals down more than 25%; sweet potato more than 50% above the same month in 2025; rice up more than 10% in a month. These triggers release actions 7 and 8.

Corrections: triggers must be in nominal kina at Gordons, because the bulletin publishes real 2021 prices. There is no bag-count series anywhere, so the threshold cannot be set until the log has run for a few weeks.

7. NCDC suspends Gordons table fees for the drought months once a price trigger from action 6 is crossed

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · FOOD SUPPLY · HISTORIAN | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
NCDC (decision); Moresby North-East District Development Authority could backfill	Decision in October; release on trigger	Forgone revenue, at most ~K0.58–1.03M over 90 days	Resellers leaving the market, and buyers facing fewer sellers and higher prices

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Tables cost K5 a day or K35 a week. At opening in 2019, vendors who could not pay moved outside the gate, and in 2020 they asked for K2. When Highlands prices rise, a reseller's margin shrinks; the fee is one cost the city controls. The 2026 Supplementary Budget lets each district spend K5m of money it already holds on the El Niño response, so the Moresby North-East authority could cover NCDC's lost fees against the same trigger.

Corrections: the cost is arithmetic, not a published figure: 1,292 vendors expected at opening to a 2,290-table limit × K5 × 90 days, assuming every table is filled every day. No precedent of NCDC waiving fees, and no legal basis, was found. That a K5m line exists for Moresby North-East, or who controls it, is unconfirmed.

8. Pre-arrange price-triggered support for vendors and households: a mobile-money cash pilot through an NGO, and short working-capital loans for resellers if the Gordons Mama Bank point still operates

UNVERIFIED | FOOD SUPPLY · PHILANTHROPIST · ECONOMIST · SKEPTIC | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Save the Children PNG or another NGO with a cash record (pilot); Women's Micro Bank (loans)	**Register and test wallets in October and November; release on trigger**	**Ceiling only: $60k cash, $30k loans**	**Meals skipped as prices rise; stalls emptying when resellers run out of cash**

The Skeptic's lesson from 1997 is that people mostly saved themselves through shops, wages, and relatives, and that the market, the trucks, and the cash should not be broken. Cash spent at Gordons stalls supports both buyers and sellers, where free rice would replace purchases there. UNCDF opened a Mama Bank access point inside Gordons Market in May 2022, and Women's Micro Bank had more than 95,000 clients in September 2026. Size any transfer to a month's food need and repeat it; do not hand out token amounts.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Unverified: no PNG precedent for disaster cash by mobile money was found; the 1.6 million CellMoni users claimed by one lens could not be sourced (the published figure is more than 100,000); whether the Gordons access point still runs is unknown; and the Mama Bank programme reached about 40 vendors per market, below this scale. Public health ranks cash lowest, because trials of cash on child wasting are mixed. If Highlands supply is the binding limit, cash and credit raise prices, so pair both with the action 6 log.

9. ICCC publishes weekly rice and flour margins through March 2027, and importers are asked to commit voluntarily to three to four months of stock

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Independent Consumer and Competition Commission (ICCC); Department of Agriculture with Trukai and other importers	November	Near zero	Unjustified rice price rises when households switch from sweet potato to rice

The 1997 shock reached town through imported rice, and the review of that drought urged checks on "unjustified price rises of imported rice and wheat". Rice, flour, and sugar have been "declared monitored goods" since 2007, so the ICCC already watches their prices; publishing margins weekly is the step it can take now. Trukai played a visible role in 1997–98.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: no source shows the ICCC can require importers to hold stock, so any stock commitment is voluntary. Whether the ICCC's August 2024 proposal for wider price caps was adopted is unconfirmed. With no 2026 export bans and high global stocks, the risk is a retail price spike, not rice running out.

10. PNG Red Cross requests a drought DREF from the IFRC now, sized at about CHF 150–250k on precedent

CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
PNG Red Cross Society; IFRC Disaster Response Emergency Fund pays	October	Paid by the DREF	Money arriving only after the outbreak, as it always has here

Nothing is pre-arranged for Papua New Guinea: no IFRC anticipatory protocol, no drought cover with the Pacific Catastrophe Risk Insurance Company, and no 2026 drought or El Niño DREF. The 2015 drought DREF was CHF 150,669; the April 2026 Cyclone Maila DREF was CHF 250k. PNG Red Cross's only 2026 El Niño money found is a QBE Foundation grant of about K14,300 for awareness.

11. Push for the World Bank and AIIB disaster credit to be approved in October, then for the state-of-emergency declaration that releases it

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Treasury and the National Executive Council; World Bank and AIIB lend	Approval expected October; declaration after	Up to US$62.5M concessional credit	The cheapest disaster money arriving in February instead of before the peak

The 1 September 2026 Supplementary Budget sets aside K500m for a national El Niño response and lets districts and provinces spend K665m they already hold, against K1,110m on fuel relief. It says up to K300m of World Bank money "will require the declaration of a national emergency." The instrument is a catastrophe deferred drawdown option: US$50M from the World Bank and US$12.5M from AIIB, triggered by a state-of-emergency declaration. No national El Niño declaration had been made as of October.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the credit is not yet approved (AIIB lists approval for October 2026), so a declaration on its own releases nothing today. The available sum is US$62.5M, not the US$162.5M one lens added up; most of the AIIB loan is not contingent. The K665m is existing district money, not new money. The budget does not say who controls the K500m.

12. Water PNG publishes its plan for the Rouna 1/3 main: when the spare pipe and clamps are ordered, and what happens in a burst. Repair bursts and replace illegal taps with metered community standpipes; do not disconnect settlements

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Water PNG; settlement water committees for standpipes	Plan before December	Pipe not quoted; standpipe arrears K200–300k at some sites	A weeks-long outage for half the city during the peak

The city still runs on one reservoir (Sirinumu) and one 1960s main. In 1997 the Rouna hydro station was shut to keep drinking water flowing. In 2015, 56% of supply (95 of 170 megalitres a day) was lost to illegal connections and broken pipes, and the dam fell from 49% to below 35% by February 2016. The Bunu river source, a K419m, 50-megalitre-a-day "drought-resilient" alternative announced in 2021, has a loan pledge but no evidence of construction. Each El Niño has met the same system, and the city has got through by rationing rather than building.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: a large-diameter spare pipe cannot credibly arrive by end-October, so the ask is a published order and a burst plan. Community standpipes already exist under water committees, but some carry K200–300k in arrears; settle the payment arrangement before the peak, as the 8-Mile standpipe project did. Rationing since 1 May could not be confirmed.

13. Test fevers for dengue as well as malaria at Gordons Clinic, and cover stored-water drums

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
NCD Provincial Health Authority	Now	Within clinic supplies (test kits not costed)	Dengue treated as malaria; mosquitoes breeding in stored water

At Port Moresby General Hospital in 2013, 14.9% of 134 outpatients with fever tested positive for dengue, against 1.5% for malaria (Asigau et al. 2015). Rationing increases household water storage, which is where dengue mosquitoes breed.

Caveats: one hospital, thirteen years ago. PNG was absent from the Pacific's 2025 dengue outbreak list, but its surveillance is weak, so absence is not evidence of no dengue. Whether Gordons Clinic holds dengue rapid tests is unknown.

14. Confirm where Gordons TB patients are treated now, and keep them on treatment through rationing*

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
NCD Provincial Health Authority with the National TB Program	Now; one phone call	Within existing programme	Patients lost to treatment when clinics move or close

NCD has 1,117 new TB cases per 100,000 people a year (PATH, 2025). In November 2024 the hospital's TB ward was full and it planned to move its TB clinic to Six Mile. At the hospital, 22% of drug-resistant TB patients were lost before treatment began and 24% during it. Malnutrition worsens TB outcomes, which ties this action to action 2.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: Gordon's 2016 move of TB services to Six Mile was temporary, for renovations, and the clinic reopened with TB testing and care. Whether the hospital's planned move happened is unconfirmed.

15. Line up fire water for the Gabaka Street industrial area, and clear the market drains before the rains

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
PNG Fire Service with NCDC; ward councillors for drains	Late November	Low; a tanker agreement	Oil-fed fires when hydrants lose pressure; flood closures like April 2023

On 9 August 2023 a warehouse fire on Gabaka Street spread through spilled oil, and hydrants lose pressure under rationing. List static water stores and tankers, and enforce oil-spill containment. After rain on 4 April 2023, floodwater covered Gordons Market and it was closed; the 2014 plan to raise the site 1.5 metres with new drainage was never shown to be delivered.

Corrections: the April 2023 flood closure was verified from The National in the first version but could not be re-found in this one.

16. For 2027, not now: fund small-quantity nutrient supplements for children aged 6–24 months in the settlements

UNVERIFIED (FEASIBILITY) | PUBLIC HEALTH | INVENTORY: NOT QUERIED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
UNICEF PNG with the National Department of Health	Procure for the 2027 dry season	Not costed	Child deaths in the next drought

Across 13 trials with 34,051 children, small-quantity lipid nutrient supplements were associated with 27% lower all-cause mortality (Stewart et al. 2020). No programme or supply of them was found in PNG, so a November start would mean new procurement. It is listed so the evidence is not lost, not as an action for this peak.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	PNG Red Cross	NCD Health Authority	UNICEF PNG	NCDC Markets	Water PNG	Vendor leaders	Churches / youth leaders	FPDA	ICCC	Treasury / NEC	Fire Service
1. Rehydration salts; backup clinic rule	**A/R**	**R**	**C**	**C**		**R**	**I**				
2. Malnutrition screening and treatment	**R**	**A/R**	**R**	**C**		**I**	**C**				
3. Sachets; containers; water points	**A/R**	**C**		**R**	**C**	**R**	**R**				
4. Zone notice relayed; early water point	**R**			**C**	**A/R**	**R**	**R**				
5. Keep the market open; phone tree				**A/R**		**R**	**R**				
6. Weekly food log; FPDA price rounds				**A/R**		**R**		**R**	**I**		
7. Fee suspension on a price trigger				**A/R**		**C**		**C**		**I**	
8. Cash pilot; reseller loans	**C**			**C**		**R**	**C**	**C**		**I**	
9. Rice margins; importer stock								**C**	**A/R**	**C**	
10. Drought DREF request	**A/R**	**C**	**I**							**I**	
11. Disaster credit; emergency declaration	**I**									**A/R**	
12. Rouna plan; standpipes, no disconnection				**C**	**A/R**		**C**			**I**	
13. Dengue testing; covered drums	**R**	**A/R**				**R**					
14. TB site and continuity		**A/R**				**I**					
15. Fire water; drains				**R**	**C**						**A/R**
16. Nutrient supplements (2027)		**R**	**A/R**							**I**	

The National TB Program is responsible with the health authority on row 14; the Moresby North-East District Development Authority could backfill row 7; Save the Children PNG or another NGO with a cash record would be accountable for row 8 once one is confirmed, which is why that row has no A. What the chart shows: **NCDC Markets is accountable for the three food rows and the open-market row**, all of which ask it to work against its habits of charging fees, closing, and clearing. **Vendor leaders are the delivery channel for nine rows and accountable for none**, and nobody has confirmed who speaks for the vendors in 2026. That is the first call to make.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Amounts are in US dollars and sit *inside* the city-wide Port Moresby envelope; do not add them. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what Gordons can spend before the peak.

FLOOR

TARGET

CEILING

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

$42k	**$67k**	**$187k**	**Whether UNICEF's therapeutic food already covers Gordons; no malnutrition rate or population count exists**

Floor: sachets 1,000 households × 120 days × 2 × $0.10 = $24k + rehydration salts and zinc $5k = $29k × 1.25 for delivery and volunteers = $36k, + malnutrition screening $6k = **$42k**. **Target:** floor + outpatient treatment of about 100 severely malnourished children × $250 = $25k = **$67k**. **Ceiling:** target + lidded containers 1,000 × $12 × 1.25 = $15k + price-triggered cash 500 households × $40 × 3 months = $60k + reseller loans $30k + five water points × $3k = $15k (only after NCDC commits in writing) = **$187k**. The target fell 18% in verification, from the panel's $82k, because containers moved to the ceiling for want of a sourced cost. It is 31% above the first version's $51k because child-malnutrition treatment is new. The $250 per child sits inside the published range of $56–805; if UNICEF stock covers the food, the treatment line falls toward the cost of staff time. The sachet price is verified; the screening, container, and water-point costs are assumptions.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT (TARGET)	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
PNG Red Cross, NCD branch, via vendor leaders	Actions 1 and 3: sachets, rehydration salts, zinc	$36,000	Pre-positioned stock with hygiene promotion	Water treatment: under-5 death odds down 24–27% (Kremer et al. 2023); sachet price verified. The NCD branch's record at this scale was not found; its 2015 drought work was in Western Highlands	Partially confirmed
NCD Provincial Health Authority, with PNG Red Cross screening	Action 2: arm-tape screening	$6,000	Direct grant	Assumed cost; feeds treatment below	Partially confirmed
NCD Provincial Health Authority, with UNICEF supply	Action 2: outpatient treatment	$25,000 (upper bound)	Top-up to an existing scheme	$203 per child treated, $53 per year of healthy life (Bachmann 2009, Lusaka); release only after UNICEF confirms stock	Partially confirmed
PNG Red Cross	Action 3: lidded containers	$0 (ceiling $15k)	Pre-positioned stock	$12 kit unsourced; Oxfam gave containers in the 2015 drought	Unverified

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT (TARGET)	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
NGO with a PNG cash record, to be confirmed	Action 8: price-triggered cash	$0 (ceiling $60k)	Unconditional cash transfer on a trigger	No PNG disaster mobile-money precedent; PNG Red Cross and World Vision have no cash record found here	Unverified
Women's Micro Bank (Mama Bank)	Action 8: reseller working capital	$0 (ceiling $30k)	Recoverable loan	Gordons access point opened May 2022; 2026 status unknown; past reach about 40 vendors per market	Partially confirmed
NCDC Markets	Action 3: water points at the bus stop and gate	$0 (ceiling $15k)	Released only on a written upkeep commitment	Unit cost and the market's water supply unconfirmed	Conditional

The funder's one thing: the food lens raises the ceiling, not the floor. Cash and credit are the right instincts for a market suburb, but every published mortality estimate still favours clean water and treating children who are already malnourished. Fund those now, and pre-sign the cash with a price trigger so the food money moves the day the Highlands bags stop arriving, not after a needs assessment. No overlap was found with the national K500m, the district allocations, or PNG Red Cross's QBE grant, none of which names an item in Gordons.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives, money, or trust here. The first six are new in this revision.

Route relief through MPs' district funds or electorate offices

CONTRAINDICATED

In the 2015 drought there was no new money: each district could spend K2m of its existing service-improvement fund, run by boards chaired by MPs, and relief went out from the MP's own village ("this is our turn, you will have yours"). The rice went through MPs, and a review found it "unclear what was distributed where". In 1997 MPs dumped food on airstrips that the elderly could not reach. The 2026 budget repeats the design, with K5m per district drawn from existing funds, a year before the 2027 election.

Instead: one coordinator outside the MPs' line (the churches' coordination in 2015 was rated 5 out of 5), targeting by need, and published beneficiary lists that are aggregate or coded, never names and locations (see the next item but one).

Disconnect "illegal" settlement water connections during rationing

CONTRAINDICATED

Water PNG is already removing illegal connections, and in February 2017 a drive at Gordon found 96 and fined K560 for reconnection. The 2010 cholera hit the poorly watered settlements of Wanigela, Erima, 8-Mile, and 9-Mile. Cutting connections during a drought pushes people onto unsafe water when cholera risk is highest.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: repair bursts, and replace illegal taps with metered community standpipes, with the arrears arrangement agreed before the peak (action 12).

Map households or survey with clipboards in settlements facing eviction

CONTRAINDICATED

Police hold 2026 eviction orders for the Erima Wildlife ridge and Tete, 9-Mile has a separate court order, and Gordon appears in reporting on planned operations. Two people died and at least 150 homes were destroyed at Rabiagini in January 2026. No case of survey data being used to evict was found, but a stranger counting houses will be read as the advance party, and people will hide the children who most need screening.

Instead: go in through a church or youth leader, name the organisation and say what it is not (not NCDC, not police), and never hand lists to the city or the police.

Hand out token rations, such as 10 kg of rice per family

CONTRAINDICATED

The 2015 ration was 10 kg of rice per family: "enough rice for less than a week (i.e. nutritionally meaningless)", in the words of the Australian aid evaluation.

Instead: size any transfer to a month's food need and repeat it through the peak (action 8).

Impose emergency price caps on rice or flour

CONTRAINDICATED

Prices set below market cause shortages and black markets, and the World Bank finds caps help the better-off more. The ICCC proposed wider price-setting powers in August 2024. No PNG shortage caused by price controls has been documented, so this rests on the general economics and on the fragility of a rice market with one dominant importer.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: weekly published margins, building on the ICCC's existing monitoring (action 9).

Give free rice in town instead of cash or vouchers spendable at the stalls

`CONTRAINDICATED · PRECAUTION`

The reasoning is that free rice replaces purchases at Gordons just as resellers' Highlands supply fails. This is an inference: no Melanesian case of aid depressing local market sales was found, and the Pacific cash evidence (Fiji after Cyclone Winston) went through a welfare register that Port Moresby lacks. If supply is the limit, cash can push prices up instead.

Instead: cash or vouchers spendable at Gordons stalls and nearby stores, paired with the weekly price log (actions 6 and 8).

Clear or ban vendors during the dry season

`CONTRAINDICATED`

In August 2012 police cleared the Gordon betel-nut market and fired shots into the air. In April 2019 police cleared vendors near the Gordon barracks and stones and bottles were thrown. In 2019 NCDC banned cooked-food street sellers city-wide, and Gordons was too full to take them. The sellers come back; what is lost is their income and their trust.

Instead: a moratorium on clearances agreed with vendor leaders, and health inspectors instead of rangers (action 5).

Close the market as the answer to an incident

`CONTRAINDICATED`

Closures in 2011, 2011–12, 2014, and 2017 each cut food supply and income across the suburbs that rely on Gordons. Lost income has never been measured, so the case rests on what a closure does to food access in a drought, when prices are already rising.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: more police and a mediation meeting, as in 2011, and a pre-agreed relocation site, as in 2014 (action 5).

Run one large distribution inside the gated market or at one crowded point

CONTRAINDICATED · PRECAUTION

Facilities inside an 8am–4pm gate miss the buyers and sellers outside it. Gordons is a mixed-ethnic flashpoint: the January 2011 clash between Hela and Enga groups began over a snatched phone, with five deaths reported and two to three confirmed by police, and clashes recurred in October 2024. No fight at a Gordons relief distribution was found; this is a precaution.

Instead: several small, scheduled points with posted quantities, run with leaders from different groups, at the bus stop and outside the gate.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1997–98	Strong El Niño drought and Highlands frosts	Hundreds dead nationally, mostly remote; no NCD toll	Rouna hydro shut to save drinking water; rice imports up 66,000 t, 76% sold through shops
May–Dec 2010	Cholera in NCD settlements	6 deaths and 250+ cases by mid-May; 219 admitted in December, from Wanigela, Erima, 8-Mile, 9-Mile	Oxfam hygiene kits in settlements
Jan 2011	Clash between Highlands groups at the market	5 reported dead, 2–3 confirmed; market closed	Police-brokered peace meeting
2011–2017	Closures (2011–12, Nov 2014, Sep 2017) and clearances (2012, 2019)	Shots fired 2012; stones thrown 2019	Bus stop moved to Unagi Oval (2014)

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2015–16	Strong El Niño drought	Sirinumu fell from 49% to below 35%; 56% of supply lost to leaks and tampering	Relief through MPs' district funds; rice sales up 35–40%; sweet potato prices nearly tripled in affected markets (WFP survey, early 2016)
Nov 2019	Rebuilt market opens	K5 a day; Jan 2020 "no customers"	Buyers followed the buses
2021	Bunu "drought-resilient" water source announced (K419m)	—	Loan pledged; no construction found
May 2022	Mama Bank access point opens inside Gordons Market	—	2026 status unknown
Apr–Aug 2023	Flood closes the market; Gabaka Street warehouse fire spread by oil	—	2014 drainage promise unconfirmed
Oct 2024	Clashes near Gordons Market	—	100 city wardens posted at Gordons in November
Feb 2025	Gordons Clinic closed 3–9 February	Patients sent to Six Mile and 9-Mile	—
Jan–Apr 2026	Evictions (Rabiagini) and eviction orders (Erima ridge, Tete)	2 dead; 150+ homes destroyed	PM asked for a slowdown on 1 April
Apr–Jun 2026	Staple prices rise	Sweet potato +35%, taro +43% year on year (real)	FPDA Port Moresby rounds lapse in July–August
Aug 2026	Rouna 1/3 leaks; four-zone rationing; Gordons split across Zones 2 and 4	No spare pipe in the country	Court order clears a landowner blockade for repairs

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Sep 2026	Supplementary Budget; Highlands frost and drought reported	Up to 3 million at risk nationally	K500m national response; no emergency declaration

The recurrence nobody has noticed: Gordons does have an El Niño history, but it was recorded as water infrastructure, not as market history. One reservoir, one 1960s main, and one shared hydro intake met the 1997, 2015, and 2026 events unchanged, and each time the city got through by rationing rather than building. The food side was never recorded at all: what sweet potato cost at Gordons in 1997 or 2015 is unknown. That is why action 6 starts the record now.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Cash first, to keep the market running** (Food supply, Skeptic) versus **cash last, because trials of cash on child wasting are mixed** (Public health). Resolved as: water treatment and malnutrition treatment in the target; cash pre-arranged on a price trigger in the ceiling (action 8).
- **Water tanks at the market now** (Emergency mgr, Food supply) versus **no hardware until the city commits to keeping it running** (Philanthropist, Skeptic). Resolved as a conditional ceiling line (action 3).
- **Credit and cash help resellers restock** (Food supply) versus **if Highlands output is the limit, more cash just raises prices** (verification, Skeptic). Unresolved; the weekly bag count in action 6 is what would settle it.
- **Feeding practices, not food supply, drive malnutrition here** (a Port Moresby General Hospital paediatrician, cited by Public health) versus **prices drive wasting within months** (Headey & Ruel, 44 countries). Both point to screening and treatment over food handouts.
- **Publish beneficiary lists** (Skeptic, against political capture) versus **never record names in eviction-listed settlements** (Frontline). Resolved as: publish aggregate or coded lists only.
- **City wardens as health messengers** (Frontline) versus **their brief to discourage illegal vending**. The same wardens enforcing against street sellers will not be trusted to help them; unresolved, and their 2026 deployment is unconfirmed.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

Who speaks for Gordons in 2026. No lens could confirm whether the Vendors Association still operates, who leads it, which churches and youth groups serve the settlements, or who the ward councillors are. Nine of sixteen actions run through vendor leaders, so this matters more

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

than any single figure in the report. Nor could any lens find a malnutrition rate for NCD (the last national nutrition survey was about fifteen years ago), the current Sirinumu level, or whether rationing is still running. One phone call each to NCDC Markets, UN Women PNG, and the NCD Provincial Health Authority would close most of these gaps.

HOW TO READ THIS

METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; food price shocks, malnutrition, water-borne and mosquito-borne disease, fire, and flood are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record and the supply-chain evidence rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED

METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request was for a PO box in Port Moresby, which geocodes to two places; the first version was built for Gordons, and a city-wide Port Moresby briefing exists separately. This revision reruns Gordons with a food supply chain lens added. Gordons is treated as the suburb in Moresby North-East around Gordons Market, the industrial area, and the bus stop at Unagi Oval; its boundary could not be confirmed. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as the report records it: National Capital District, PNG, inferred. Mortality figures exist only at that scale; sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only and gives no figure for Papua New Guinea. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and, new in this revision, a food supply chain analyst) each researched Gordons independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. Each was given the facts verified in the first version and asked to build beyond them and flag contradictions. The food lens traced four links: where the food comes from, how it is moved and stored, how the market sells it, and how households buy it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Six lenses converged on food and nutrition. Because much of the price and cash evidence comes from outside Melanesia, cash and credit were ranked below water treatment and malnutrition treatment, which have local precedent or direct mortality evidence. Contradictions were kept. Each action was given a payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Six verifier agents checked the health actions, the food supply chain facts and actions, the financial actions, the water and community actions, the funding envelope, and the contraindicated items, on evidence, transferability, and feasibility, mostly by fetching the 2026 Supplementary Budget speech, AIIB and IFRC records, the IFPRI/FPDA papers, PubMed Central, Cochrane, and PNG news pages directly. Financial actions were checked for availability, payer, trigger, and redundancy. The envelope was re-summed.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here; "precaution" marks those resting on thin evidence.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not queried; the inventory builds its listings with JavaScript, and a plain fetch returns no entries. Every action is tagged "not queried".
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (oral rehydration salts and zinc, vitamin A, therapeutic food and nutrient supplements, water treatment, and TB treatment) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total. The Gordons envelope is built bottom-up from unit costs, and assumptions are labelled. The fee-suspension figure and the cash illustration are shown as arithmetic.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one at Gordons was interviewed. Tok Pisin and Motu sources were not searched. No Water PNG, NBC, or EMTV item after August 2026 was found, so the October state of rationing and the dam is unknown. Oxfam's 2010 page returned 403, and one NBC 2026 article could be read only through search summaries. FPDA prices are in 2021 kina and have gaps for Port Moresby.

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Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 11 October 2026 for Gordons, Port Moresby, Papua New Guinea; revises the briefing of 10 October 2026. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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